

Ideation Phase

Empathize & Discover

Date	01-10-2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-8759
Project Name	Import Data using Transform Maps
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

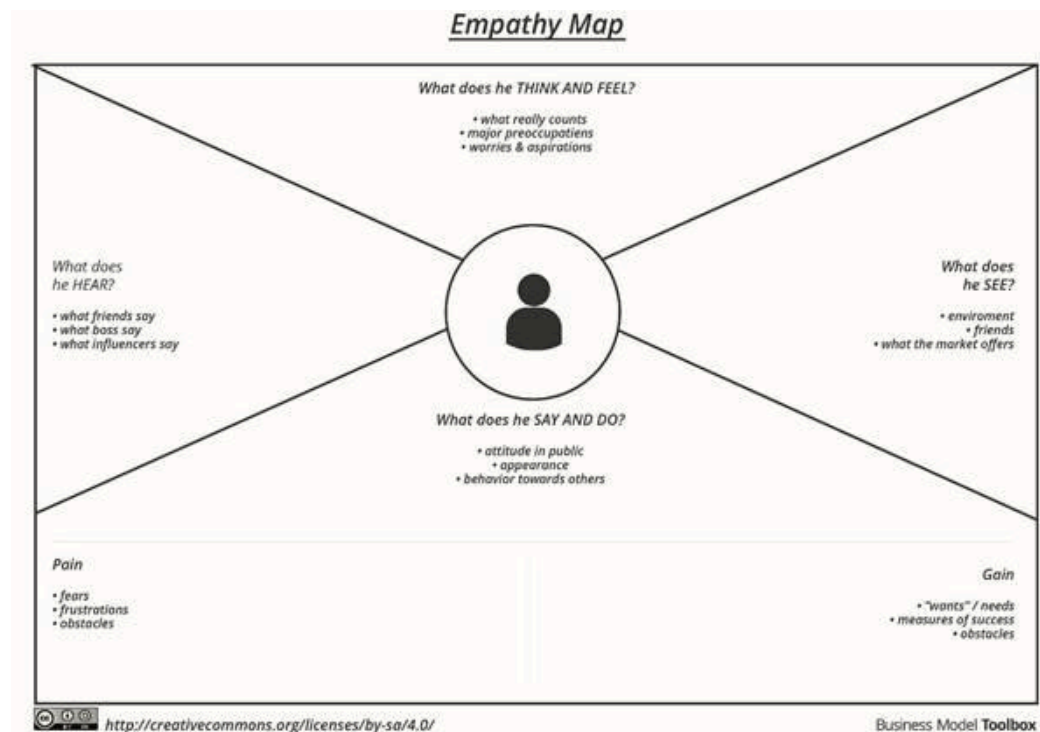
Empathy Map Canvas:

An empathy map is a simple, easy-to-digest visual that captures knowledge about a user's behaviours and attitudes.

It is a useful tool to help teams better understand their users.

Creating an effective solution requires understanding the true problem and the person who is experiencing it. The exercise of creating the map helps participants consider things from the user's perspective along with his or her goals and challenges.

Example:



Empathy Map: Import Data using Transform Maps

User: ServiceNow Administrator / HR Data Admin

Goal: migrate bulk employee data received in Excel into ServiceNow quickly, accurately and without duplicates.

Says

- "Our new employee data always arrives as an Excel sheet."
- "Can we load all the records in bulk instead of typing each one?"
- "Please make sure no duplicate employee records are created."
- "Did all 15 records really make it into the table?"

Thinks

- Manual entry of many employees is slow and error-prone.
- What happens if the same file is imported twice?
- Are the sheet columns mapped to the right target fields?
- I need a repeatable process that I can trust.

Does

- Prepares the spreadsheet and downloads it as .xlsx.
- Loads the file into an Import Set staging table.
- Maps source fields to target fields using a Transform Map.
- Runs the transform and verifies records in the target table.
- Re-imports updated sheets and checks insert, update and ignored counts.

Feels

- Anxious about duplicates and overwriting good data.
- Frustrated by repetitive manual data entry.
- Confident when the success message and record counts match.
- Relieved when Coalesce updates records instead of duplicating them.

Pains

- Manual entry is slow and prone to typing mistakes.
- Duplicate records appear when the same data is imported again.
- Inconsistent data such as name, email and department spelling or case.
- Hard to tell what was inserted, updated or ignored.
- Import Set and Transform Map concepts are confusing for beginners.

Gains

- All records imported in a single run.
- Coalesce on Employee ID keeps the table clean and consistent.
- Transform History shows inserts, updates, ignored rows and errors.
- Reports and a dashboard give a visual view of employee data.
- A reusable process for every future import.

Ideation Phase

Define the Problem Statements

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Customer Problem Statement :

Create a problem statement to understand your customer's point of view. The Customer Problem Statement helps you focus on what matters to create experiences people will love.

A well-articulated customer problem statement allows you and your team to find the ideal solution for the challenges your customers face. Throughout the process, you'll also be able to empathize with your customers, which helps you better understand how they perceive your product or service.

Problem Statement (PS)	I am (Customer)	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	HR / ServiceNow administrator who receives bulk employee data in Excel	import the employee spreadsheet into ServiceNow quickly and accurately	entering records manually is slow and error-prone	there is no staged, mapped import process from the spreadsheet to the target table	Frustrated and stressed
PS-2	ServiceNow administrator who maintains employee records	re-import updated employee data without creating duplicates	the same employees get inserted again and existing values are not updated	no unique key (Coalesce on Employee ID) is set in the Transform Map	Worried and unsure about data accuracy

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization

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Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization :

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

Problem statement (HMW)	How might we import bulk employee data from an Excel spreadsheet into ServiceNow quickly and accurately, without creating duplicate records?
Team gathering	Team members meet (in person or online) and share the Import Set and Transform Map pre-work: sample employee spreadsheet, target table and the PS-1 and PS-2 problem statements.
Goal of the session	Generate as many ideas as possible for a reliable, repeatable spreadsheet import, then select the ideas to build.
Session plan	10 minutes to prepare, 1 hour to collaborate. Brainstorm 10 min, group ideas 20 min, prioritize 20 min.
Key rules of brainstorming	Stay on topic. Defer judgment. Go for volume. Encourage wild ideas. Listen to others. If possible, be visual.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

Brainstorm: ideas written by each team member (10 minutes)

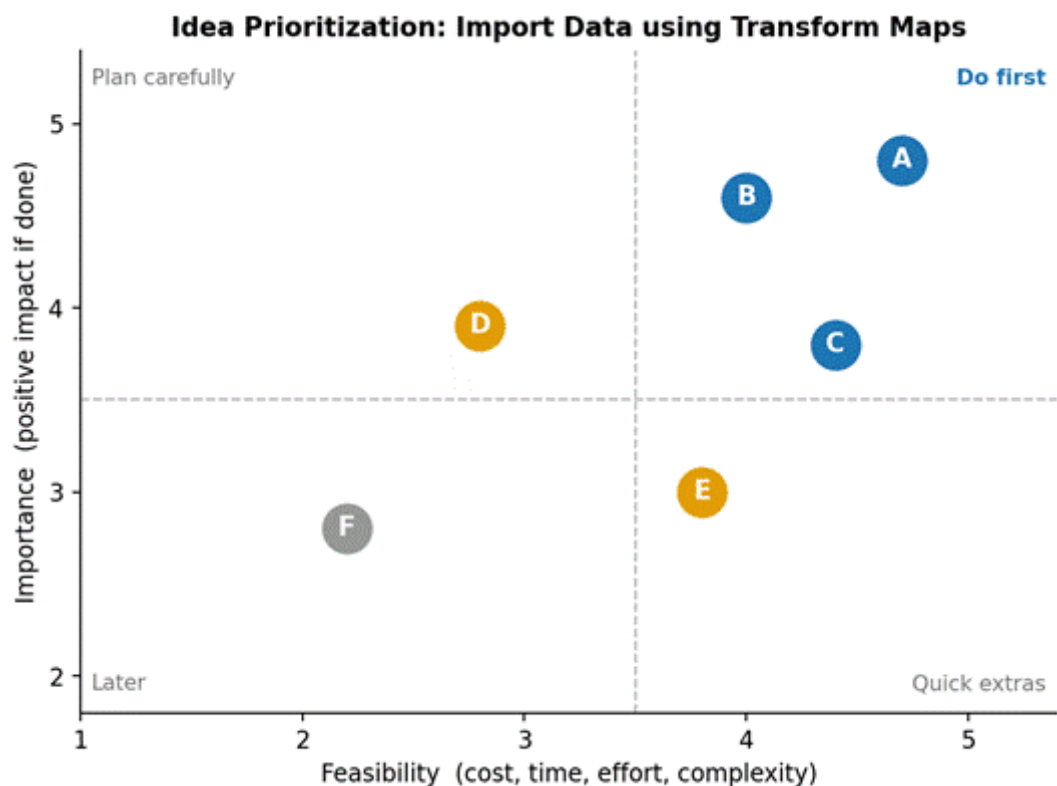
Person 1	Person 2	Person 3	Person 4
Upload the Excel file through Load Data into a staging table	Use Employee ID as the Coalesce key	Check the imported records in the target table list	Create reports by Department and Location, plus a list report
Auto-map matching fields with a Transform Map	Update existing records instead of inserting duplicates	Normalize Department and Location spelling and case	Combine the reports in an HR dashboard
Show a success message and row counts after the load	Re-import the same file to confirm rows are ignored	Review Transform History for inserts, updates, ignored and errors	Use a scheduled data source for automatic imports (future)

Group ideas: similar ideas clustered and labeled (20 minutes)

Group	Group label (sentence-like)	Ideas in the group
1	Load spreadsheet data through a staging table	Upload the Excel file via Load Data; auto-map matching fields; show success message and row counts
2	Prevent duplicate records with Coalesce	Use Employee ID as the Coalesce key; update existing records; re-import the same file to confirm ignored rows
3	Verify the import and improve data quality	Check the target table list; normalize Department and Location; review Transform History
4	Give HR visibility with reports and a dashboard	Reports by Department and Location; list report; HR dashboard
5	Automate imports in the future	Scheduled data source for automatic imports

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

Prioritize: ideas placed on the importance and feasibility grid (20 minutes)



ID	Idea	Importance (1-5)	Feasibility (1-5)	Decision
A	Load Excel via Import Set and Transform Map	5	5	Implemented
B	Coalesce on Employee ID	5	4	Implemented
C	Verify with Transform History and target table list	4	4	Implemented
D	Normalize data and set mandatory fields	4	3	Next improvement
E	Reports and HR dashboard	3	4	Implemented as extension
F	Scheduled data source for automatic imports	3	2	Future scope

